CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 15: **Cultural Currents: India from the 13th to the 17th Century** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. What can be concluded from the presence of Rajput painters in Mughal ateliers? 1

(a) artistic exchange between courts **(b)** war only
(c) trade only **(d)** conflict only

2. Which of the following is a primary source for the period? 1

(a) Ain-i-Akbari **(b)** a modern textbook
(c) a documentary **(d)** an atlas

3. Which factor most explains the spread of Sufi ideas among common people? 1

(a) use of Latin texts **(b)** use of English schools
(c) use of Sanskrit alone **(d)** use of local languages and music

4. Why is the Kerala School significant globally? 1

(a) it wrote epics
(b) it built ships
(c) it anticipated results of European mathematics
(d) it invented printing

5. What is the main reason that Persian words entered Indian languages? 1

(a) trade only
(b) war
(c) Persian was the language of administration
(d) religion only

6. Why might Akbar have commissioned the Razmnama? 1

(a) to make the Mahabharata available in Persian
(b) to record land revenue
(c) to replace Persian with Sanskrit
(d) to hide the epic from readers

7. Which source would best help us understand village schools in the 17th century? 1

(a) a modern film **(b)** a coin
(c) a map **(d)** an Italian traveller's account

8. Why is paper's arrival called important for knowledge? 1

(a) it weakened script **(b)** it raised cost
(c) it ended copying **(d)** it lowered cost of books

9. **Assertion (A):** The Alvars composed hymns in praise of Vishnu. 1
Reason (R): The Nayanars composed hymns in praise of Vishnu as well.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Dara Shikoh translated the Upanishads into Arabic. 1
Reason (R): Translation into Persian made the Upanishads known beyond India.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why do dargahs attract diverse visitors? 2

12. What does a GI tag add to a traditional craft? 2

13. Why did Mughal rulers patronise Indian painters? 2

14. How did languages grow through contact? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse how Sufi music blended Indian and Persian traditions. 3

16. Examine the significance of the Kerala School's work. 3

17. Analyse how crafts like Banarasi and pashmina survive today. 3

OR

Examine the role of patrons in the music of the period. 3

18. Evaluate how food and dress show cultural exchange. 3

OR

Discuss the value of intangible heritage like Durga Puja. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Sufism is a path of Islam stressing devotion and a personal inner search for God. Devotional songs of Sufi saints blending Indian and Persian styles are called qawwalis, associated with Amir Khusro. Dargahs of the Chishti saints Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti and Nizamuddin Auliya at Ajmer and Delhi draw visitors of all faiths. 5
(i) What is Sufism?
(ii) Name the musical form associated with Amir Khusro.
(iii) Where are the dargahs of the two Chishti saints?
(iv) How do Sufi shrines promote harmony?

20. Analyse the factors that preserved learning and science in this period. 5

OR

Assess the contribution of Dara Shikoh and Akbar to dialogue between traditions. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks